

Crema Italia — Store Operating Standards

Version 1.2 · 2026-07-13 **Source of truth:** this file (`docs/standards/store-operating-standards.md`) in the theme repo. **Companion standards:** Brand Standards v2.1 (look & voice) · Collaboration Standard v1.1 (how we work).

v1.2 (2026-07-13) replaced additive discount stacking with a **no-stacking, highest-wins** (`MAX`) rule (§3): a customer receives only the single highest discount they qualify for — a founder who is also a first-time buyer gets **12%** (not 17%); a first-time buyer who earns the 3-bag volume tier gets **10%** (not 15%). The `MAX` rule is the cap, so there is no separate discount ceiling. Split the delivery mechanism (standing benefit auto-applied server-side vs campaign discounts via link). **BFCM** is no longer additive — it is a flat candidate in the `MAX`. Marked the **Referral** reward + capture **TBD** (§3, §12.6) since the former "free 100g bag" has no standalone SKU. Annotated the vestigial **Sorpresa 250g / O250g** matrix cells as retired (§2.2). **Note:** the POC discount code still stacks and is now knowingly behind this Standard — a POC/production fix, tracked separately.

v1.1 (2026-07-13) closed the three open decisions from v1.0 §12: per-SKU markup override added (§2.2), price-maintenance tool approach set (§11), and the subscriber-benefit / pause-cancel model settled (§3.1) — including making **Founding Member status durable** (account-level, lost only on account closure), which supersedes the 2026-07-10 Active/Forfeited model (§4).

What this document is. The canonical, human-and-machine-readable statement of **how the Crema Italia store buys, prices, sells, and fulfils** — the commerce mechanics. Brand Standards owns how the store *looks and speaks*; this owns how it *does business*. It is a **Standard** (what is true *now*), not a log (what changed, when) — history lives in `CLAUDE.md` §9 and `Coordination/DECISIONS_LOG.md`.

How to use it. When a commerce rule changes, update THIS file in the same pass and bump the version, then log the event. Other documents (the POC, code comments, `CLAUDE.md`) should *point at* this file, never restate its rules — restating is what causes drift. The POC is an ephemeral mock we build *from*; this document is what we build *to*, and what future alterations are measured against.

Provenance. v1.0 consolidates the rules previously locked across the (now-retired) Shopify Magic Build Prompt v3 FINAL, the `01_Metafield_Reference` doc, and the locked decisions in `CLAUDE.md` §9 (esp. 2026-06-29, 2026-07-04, 2026-07-10). Where those sources conflicted, the conflict is called out in **§12 Open Decisions** rather than silently resolved.

1. The shelves — canonical definitions

Every product lives on exactly one shelf. The four **coffee** shelves drive navigation, collections, and taxonomy; **Bottega** is a separate non-coffee retail section, not a fifth coffee shelf.

Shelf	English meaning	Commercial role	Key rules
CREMA ITALIA Roccia	"Rock / staple"	The subscription backbone — everyday coffees sold one-time and as Roccia subscriptions	Bag sizes 250g / 500g / 1kg (no 100g). The only shelf with subscriptions.
Sorpresa	"Surprise"	Discovery Tour bundles (composite BOM SKUs)	Sorpresa 100g bags exist only inside Tour bundles , never sold alone. One-time only.
Selezione	"Selection"	Premium / seasonal / limited micro-lots	One-time purchase only, never a subscription. Honest scarcity ("low inventory" under 12 units, hard cap). Active Roccia subscribers see new SKUs 48h early (Locksmith, tag <code>active-roccia</code>).
Offerta	"Offer / deal"	Aged lots moved to an honest markdown as they approach their freshness limit	Not stocked directly — items <i>transition</i> here by age (see §6). Uses the <code>0[size]</code> markup factors. Guarantee is "as-is, defects only" (see §5).
Bottega	"Shop / workshop"	Non-coffee retail: equipment, accessories, Crema Italia merch	Independent ordering experience. No roaster affiliation, no freshness/expiry logic. Never appears on roaster profiles. Never discounted for subscribers/Founding.

2. Pricing model

2.1 The formula (LOCKED)

Retail price = `SKU_LAST_COST` × Markup[Shelf, Size]

- **SKU_LAST_COST** = the US-dollar landed cost of the most recent lot purchased for that SKU (EUR purchase price + freight + tariff + handling), **locked at receipt** on the lot's variant (`landed_cost_usd`).
- **Markup** comes from the fixed matrix below, keyed by shelf and bag size.
- The retired `EUR × 0.60 × markup × 1.165` formula is **superseded — do not use**.

2.2 Markup matrix (LOCKED; the *table* is admin-configurable)

`0[size]` columns = the Offerta (aged-lot) variant of that size.

Shelf	100g	250g	500g	1kg	O100g	O250g	O500g	O1kg
Roccia	—	2.8×	2.5×	2.2×	—	2.3×	1.7×	1.5×
Sorpresa	3.7×	—	—	—	3.2×	—	—	—
Selezione	3.7×	3.0×	2.7×	2.4×	3.2×	2.5×	2.2×	1.9×
Offerta	uses the <code>0[size]</code> factor of the item's originating shelf							
Bottega	2.0× flat (1.5× if clearing)							

Sorpresa 250g / O250g are intentionally blank (retired 2026-07-13). Sorpresa ships **only as Tours** (§2.3), priced off the 100g factor (3.7× fresh / 3.2× aged); there is no standalone Sorpresa 250g product, so those cells carry no live factor. If a standalone Sorpresa bag is ever introduced, restore the cells and log it.

Per-SKU override (LOCKED 2026-07-13). The matrix is the **default** that governs every SKU by shelf/size — editing the table moves every SKU of that shelf/size together. In addition, a SKU may carry an optional `markup_override`: leave it blank (the normal case) and the SKU inherits the matrix; set it and it wins **for that SKU only**. This mirrors how `days_to_offerta` works (a default plus a per-SKU override). An override is a **deliberate exception, not the norm**, and it **routes through the same admin approval** as any price change (§2.4).

2.3 Tour / bundle pricing

- `Tour cost = Σ (component SKU_LAST_COSTs) + packaging_cost`
- `Tour retail = Tour cost × Sorpresa/100g factor (3.7×)`; an aged Tour uses `3.2×`.
- Component cost changes flow into Tour cost automatically; the customer-facing Tour price updates **only on admin approval** (same governance as any SKU).
- *Worked example:* (6.00 + 5.50 + 7.00 components) + 2.50 packaging = 21.00 → ×3.7 = **\$77.70**.

2.4 Price-update governance (LOCKED — no automatic passthrough)

A new lot never silently changes the shelf price. Instead: 1. New lot arrives → update `landed_cost_usd` → system computes the *proposed* new retail. 2. Admin is alerted ("current retail \$X; new cost would yield \$Y if approved"). 3. Admin **approves / holds (retain margin) / defers**. 4. Price changes only on explicit approval.

Rationale: avoid psychological pricing churn, protect margin on fast movers, keep pricing a deliberate decision.

3. Discounts & the subscriber privilege

No stacking — highest applicable discount wins (LOCKED 2026-07-13). A customer never receives two discounts at once. The applied rate is the `MAX` of every discount they currently qualify for; all others are obviated. This deliberately protects margin on thin per-bag markups: a founder who is also

a first-time buyer gets **12%** (not 17%); a first-time buyer who earns the 3-bag volume tier gets **10%** (not 15%). There is **no additive stacking and no separate combined cap** — the **MAX** rule is the cap. CREMA ITALIA · Store Operating Standards v1.2 · 2026-07-13 · source of truth: docs/standards/store-operating-standards.md · render — do not edit

Delivery mechanism (LOCKED): there is **NO visible promo-code field at checkout**. Discounts reach the customer by kind: the **standing subscriber / founder benefit applies automatically, server-side**, whenever the customer is signed in and benefits are on (Shopify Functions reading the entitlement tag, §11); **campaign discounts** (first-time, volume, abandoned-cart, win-back, BFCM) apply via **URL parameter or personalized email link**. Whichever mechanism fires, the customer still receives only the single highest applicable rate (the **MAX** rule above).

Discount	Rate	Applies to	Notes (every row competes in the MAX ; none stack)
Founding Member	12%	Roccia, Sorpresa, Selezione	Auto when benefits on. Founder tier of the subscriber benefit — see §4.
Active subscriber	10%	Roccia, Sorpresa, Selezione	Auto when benefits on (regular tier).
Win-back	15%	All shelves	30 days post-Roccia-cancel; one email link. Wins over the standing benefit by design.
Volume	2 bags 5% / 3+ bags 10%	Coffee shelves except Offerta/Bottega	Competes in the MAX ; for a subscriber the 10/12% already wins.
First-time buyer	5%	All shelves except Bottega	One-time, detected server-side (zero prior orders). A first-time founder/subscriber still gets 12/10% (higher).
BFCM	5%	All shelves incl. Offerta/Bottega	Manual admin toggle, site banner. A flat candidate in the MAX (no longer additive) — mainly benefits customers who hold no higher discount.
Abandoned cart	5%	All shelves	Email #3 link only; once per customer per 90 days.
Referral	TBD	TBD	Referral capture is not built yet ; reward + mechanism are open (§12.6). The former "free 100g bag" is void — 100g exists only inside Tours (§1), so there is no standalone 100g SKU to gift.

3.1 Subscriber benefits & how long they last (LOCKED 2026-07-13)

"Subscriber benefits" = the discount (12% founder / 10% regular) *and* the shipping offsets (free/reduced shipping). They are bound to being a subscriber, with a deliberate win-back grace:

- **ON** while the account has **≥1 actively-shipping subscription**. A customer may hold several; any one shipping keeps benefits on. Pausing or cancelling *some* changes nothing while another ships.
- **60-day grace**. When the account reaches **no actively-shipping subscription** — whether by **pausing all** or **cancelling all** — benefits **continue for 60 days** from that date, then lapse. The grace is intentional: it is our window to re-contact the customer and win them back on the benefits they are about to lose (FOMO), and it means no one is punished the instant they pause or cancel.

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- **Reinstatement.** Resuming or re-subscribing at **any** later date restores benefits at the account's tier — **12% if still a Founding Member, 10% if regular (§4).**
 - Benefits never apply to **Offerta or Bottega** (§3 table), regardless of tier.

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Supersedes both the older "\$45+ shipment delivered per calendar month" active-definition and the interim "cancel = immediate benefit loss" rule: **cancel-all now carries the same 60-day grace as pause-all.** The only thing that ends benefits *without* a grace is closing the entire account (§4).

No sitewide percentage-off promotional sales — the subscriber benefit is the standing perk, not a recurring sale. **No Italian-holiday discounting** — holidays are Journal editorial only.

4. Founding Member mechanic (LOCKED 2026-07-13 — supersedes 2026-07-10)

- **"Founding Member · No. NNN"** is a **durable, account-level status** — one of **222** numbered slots, granted at launch signup, with a numbered certificate. It is tied to the **account**, not to any subscription.
- **It survives cancelling any or all subscriptions.** A founder who cancels everything and re-subscribes months or years later returns a **Founding Member at 12%**. Founder status is not something a subscription action can take away.
- **The 12% is the *founder tier* of the subscriber benefit (§3.1):** a founder receives **12%** whenever subscriber benefits are ON (an actively-shipping subscription, or within the 60-day grace); a regular subscriber receives **10%** under the same conditions; benefits OFF → 0%.
- **Founding status is lost ONLY by closing the entire account** — *"Cancel the entire account,"* a distinct action from cancelling a subscription (e.g. a founder dies and a family member closes the account). On account closure the numbered founding **slot is released/retired**.
- **Retired (do not build):** the 2026-07-10 "Active/Forfeited" two-state model, the permanent 12%→10% forfeiture on a subscription cancel, and the one-way `founding_rate_forfeited` tag. **There is no permanent forfeiture** — the only terminal event for a founder is account closure.
- *Rationale:* the 12-vs-10 delta is tiny (~\$10/yr) — a pride good. Making founder status durable and always-reinstatable removes any reason a founder would fear pausing or cancelling, and keeps the win-back door open.

5. Freshness & the Offerta transition

- **Freshness statement (always paired with the actual roast date):** "Best within 60 days of roast date. For peak flavor, brew within 30 days." Never "best by" alone.
- `days_to_offerta` default **45**, admin-editable per master SKU (override per lot if needed).
- `offerta_transition_date` = `roast_date + days_to_offerta`.

- **Nightly** the system flags lots at/over their transition date. Admin sees a daily digest and approves (may auto-approve). On transition: `current_shelf` → Offerta (Shopify Flow), price recalculates to the `0[size]` factor, 3PL gets a priority-ship (FIFO) flag.
- **Offerta listing shows:** original price (struck through) + Offerta price + savings + the *actual* remaining freshness window (e.g. "best within 23 days").
- **Donation threshold:** coffee remaining after **60 days from roast** is removed from sale and donated to **Feeding Tampa Bay** (the no-waste pledge).
- **Offerta guarantee is modified:** "as-is, defects only" — the standard first-bag satisfaction guarantee (§9) does not apply to already-discounted aged lots.

6. Roccia subscriptions (Loop)

- Engine = **Loop** (native `selling_plan_groups` + Shopify Checkout + Loop-hosted portal).
- **Cadences 4 / 6 / 8 weeks.** Customer selects roaster + SKU + size (**250g / 500g / 1kg only**) + cadence.
- Every Roccia shipment: **10% off + free shipping** (no minimum).
- **Self-service controls (no fee, no minimum commitment):**
- **Skip** one shipment; **swap** roaster/SKU/size up to 48h before order lock.
- **Pause** — a single subscription **or** all subscriptions — offered as a bounded window: **[next delivery cycle]** or **[next two delivery cycles]**, then auto-resumes. Pause is a short skip, **not** a long hold: anything longer than two cycles, the customer should **cancel** instead.
- **Cancel** — a single subscription **or** all subscriptions — stops shipping immediately.
- Reaching **no actively-shipping subscription** (by pause-all or cancel-all) starts the **60-day benefits grace** (§3.1); benefits reinstate on any resume/re-subscribe. Founder status is unaffected either way (§4).
- **Pallet-timing gap policy:** when a subscriber's SKU is between pallets and can't fill the next cadence, notify 7+ days ahead with two options: (a) wait for restock (no charge until ship), or (b) substitute a similar bag **from the same roaster**. **Never** substitute from Sorpresa/Selezione/Offerta into a Roccia shipment.

7. Tours / bundles — the BOM model

A Tour (and any future bundle) is a **Bill-of-Materials SKU**: box + N component coffee SKUs + printed tasting card.

- **Browse facets are DERIVED from components, never hand-entered.** A Tour's Region / Roast / Flavor / Caffeine values are the **union** of its components (Option A: positive to a filter when **any** component matches, per axis; AND across axes). Modelled in the POC via `component_handles` + `productFacets()`.

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- **Availability is gated by components:** offered only while **all** components are in stock and within freshness; auto-pauses and returns automatically as stock rotates.

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- **On-demand 3PL fulfillment:** on order, 3PL pulls components FIFO, assembles box + bags + card, QC's all roast dates within the 60-day window, ships in 1–2 business days.
- **Substitution matrix** (admin-defined per Tour): if a component is within 7 days of its transition date or out of stock after order, 3PL may substitute a defined alternate from the same roaster; customer is told ("Same quality, same roaster, new terroir").
- **REQUIRED production capability:** an **admin-managed BOM builder** — create a Tour by naming it and selecting component SKUs, facets/availability auto-derive, and each order emits a per-order pick-pack BOM to the 3PL. No developer, no code deploy. (See §11 tooling.)

8. Fulfilment & shipping

- **US-only at launch.** No international.
- **Free** on every Roccia shipment; **free** on one-time orders **\$55+**; **flat \$8.50** USPS Ground Advantage under \$55. Free-shipping progress bar in cart, **\$55** threshold.
- **Carriers:** USPS Ground Advantage under 1 lb; UPS Ground 1 lb+.
- **Transit:** East/Southeast 2–3 business days · Midwest/Mountain 3–4 · West Coast 4–5.

9. The Crema Italia Promise

Three lines, in this exact order, on a single editorial page linked from the footer: 1. Curated with love, never aggregated. 2. Love your first bag, or we send a different one - free. 3. Cancel your subscription anytime in a couple of clicks.

Below: first-bag satisfaction guarantee (standard shelves; Offerta is "as-is, defects only" per §5), damage replacement, the freshness window, and the no-waste pledge (Feeding Tampa Bay donations).

The **exact customer-facing wording lives in the POC/theme** (the source of truth for *copy*); reproduce it from there and honor the no-em-dash rule (§10).

10. Strict exclusions (never appears on the site)

- **No grind options** anywhere — whole bean only (roasters seal valve bags at origin).
- **No claim** that we roast, blend, or process — we import and curate; the roasters roast.
- **No roast-day shipping-cadence claims** — pallets travel on a 6–10-week cadence.
- **No countdown timers, fake stock counts, or manufactured urgency** — real low-inventory and real freshness windows only.

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- **No visible promo-code field** at checkout.

- **No sitewide percentage-off promotional sales.**

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- **No emoji. No exclamation marks. No "amazing/best/you'll love it" copy.**
 - **No em-dashes in customer-facing copy** (2026-07-13) — see Brand Standards / `CLAUDE.md` §6 for the replacement rule.
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II. Data model & tooling (production)

Metafields (`crema_italia.*`): `roast_date` (Date), `lot_id` (Text), `eur_usd_rate` (Decimal), `landed_cost_usd` (Currency, locked at receipt), `markup_override` (Decimal, **optional** — blank = inherit the shelf/size matrix), `days_to_offerta` (Int), `offerta_transition_date` (Date), `current_shelf` (SingleSelect: Roccia|Sorpresa|Selezione|Offerta), `Referral_Gift_Allowed` (Boolean), plus taxonomy: `roast_level`, `flavor_profile`, `caffeine`, `shelf`, `region`, `roaster_handle`, `best_by_date`. Extend with a structured component-SKU BOM field on bundles (§7).

Customer tags: `founding-member-NNN` (durable; set at signup, removed only on account closure — NO `founding_rate_forfeited`, retired per §4), plus subscription-state tags derived from Loop (actively-shipping / in-60-day-grace / lapsed) driving the benefit gate. Auto-managed by Shopify Flow / Loop webhooks. **Entitlement logic:** `benefits_on = (≥1 actively-shipping sub) OR (within 60-day grace)`; the *standing* rate `standing = founder ? 12% : 10%` when `benefits_on`, else 0%. The **applied** discount is `MAX(standing, any qualifying campaign discount)` per the no-stacking rule (§3) — never a sum.

Automation: Shopify Flow moves `current_shelf` → Offerta on `offerta_transition_date` and tags `active-roccia` on the \$45+/month rule.

Account architecture split (LOCKED 2026-07-04): - **Loop** owns the active subscription's ship-to + payment + lifecycle notifications + the retention ("are you sure") prompt in its cancel flow. - **Native Shopify accounts** own the general address book + profile (name/email/password) + order history + buy-again + marketing consent. - **Shopify Functions + a customer tag/metafield** own the **entitlement** (who gets 12/10/0), driven by Loop webhooks — the authoritative, server-side downgrade path (a customer can cancel via an email link and never touch theme UI).

The SKU price-maintenance engine (approach LOCKED 2026-07-13 — phased). Landed-cost × markup with the approval governance (§2.4) is **not a native Shopify feature**. Chosen path: - **At launch: spreadsheet-assisted** (compute in `Crema_Italia_Landed_Cost_Model_v1.xlsx`, enter prices manually in Shopify). Adequate for the small launch catalog on a 6–10-week lot cadence; governance = admin review at entry time. Zero build. - **Automation:** use **Shopify Flow** for what it does well — the Offerta **aging** transition (date-triggered shelf move + price recalc to `0[size]` + admin alert). Native, free. - **Later:** build a **lightweight custom app** (a proposed-price approve/hold/defer queue) **when volume justifies it** — trigger = SKU count / lot velocity high enough that manual pricing becomes a chore or error-prone. Back-office only; does **not** block or shape the storefront theme build.

12. Open decisions (must close before / at production build)

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1. **Per-SKU markup override.** **RESOLVED 2026-07-13** — matrix + optional per-SKU `markup_override` (blank = inherit); override is a deliberate exception and routes through admin approval. Rule now in §2.2; field in §11.
2. **The SKU price-maintenance tool mechanism.** **RESOLVED 2026-07-13** — phased: spreadsheet + Shopify Flow (aging) at launch; lightweight custom app when volume justifies. Detail in §11.
3. **Pricing numbers never validated.** The multipliers were specified, never run against real landed costs (the POC cart is mocked). **Pre-launch:** sanity-check several real SKUs through the matrix against `Crema_Italia_Landed_Cost_Model_v1.xlsx` before charging real money.
4. **Pause-semantics reconciliation.** **RESOLVED 2026-07-13** — benefits bound to ≥ 1 actively-shipping subscription; pause-all **and** cancel-all trigger a 60-day win-back grace, then lapse; reinstated on resume/re-subscribe. Founder status made **durable** (account-level, lost only on account closure), superseding the 2026-07-10 permanent-forfeiture model. Rules in §3.1 and §4.
5. **Deferred perks.** The month-12 "complimentary Selezione bag" annual perk was deferred to post-launch — confirmed deferred, tracked here so it isn't lost.
6. **Referral program — reward + capture TBD (2026-07-13).** No referral-capture mechanism has been built, and the former "free 100g bag" reward is void (no standalone 100g SKU — 100g exists only inside Tours, §1). Both the reward form (e.g. a 250g bag, account credit) and the capture/tracking tooling are open; decide before any referral discount is enabled. The §3 table carries Referral as **TBD** until then.

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